

JAMES D. RODGERS

AI Learning Experience Designer

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SUMMARY

AI Learning Experience Designer and learning systems strategist with **15 years** of experience designing human-centered learning that drives workforce performance and measurable business outcomes. One of few practitioners with direct, **production-scale AI development experience**, having contributed to **Grok 2 and 3 at xAI**. Certified in Generative AI Applications (Purdue University). Integrates generative AI into learning design to accelerate development, personalize learning pathways, and scale content across modalities. Experienced in cross-functional collaboration, needs analysis, and translating complex technical concepts into accessible, high-impact learning that builds organizational capability and AI adoption.

SKILLS

DESIGN

- Learning systems architecture
- ADDIE, SAM, backward design
- Competency-based curriculum
- Universal Design for Learning
- Needs & performance gap analysis
- Adult learning theory
- Multimodal & blended learning

TECHNOLOGY

- Articulate 360 (Storyline & Rise)
- Generative AI integration
- Prompt engineering
- LLM fine-tuning · OpenAI API
- SCORM & xAPI · Python
- Canvas · Moodle
- LMS & LTI integration

STRATEGY

- AI adoption & change enablement
- Stakeholder engagement
- Cross-functional collaboration
- Strategic planning & development
- Instructional coaching
- Learning analytics & evaluation
- Data-driven decision-making

WORK EXPERIENCE

Aquatics Safety and Training — YMCA San Francisco

San Francisco, CA · April 2025 – Present · Part-time

- Improved branch safety audit scores from **78% to 92%** through multimedia, AI-augmented continuing education content covering water rescue, CPR, and oxygen administration.
- Backward-designed and facilitated monthly in-service trainings for 15 lifeguard staff, grounding each session in incident data and YMCA safety standards.
- Built a longitudinal performance tracking system to identify skill gaps across **130 swimmers**, using data to design targeted interventions benchmarked against national competency standards.

AI Fellow & Subject Matter Expert — Handshake AI (Contract)

San Francisco, CA · June 2025 – Present

- Evaluated agentic AI outputs for reasoning accuracy, safety alignment, and guardrail compliance — technical focus on Python and Linux-based systems in production-scale environments.
- Designed original prompt sequences using Bloom's Taxonomy to assess AI model comprehension of music theory and notation across image modalities, applying instructional design methodology to multimodal AI evaluation.
- Assessed code-generating AI behavior against functional and ethical benchmarks, contributing to responsible deployment of agentic systems.

Human Data AI Tutor — xAI

San Francisco, CA · April 2024 – April 2025

- Applied instructional design and learning science principles to evaluate and refine AI model outputs across text, audio, and visual modalities — improving reasoning accuracy in direct support of **Grok 2 and 3**.
- Designed and delivered AI literacy training for **50+** cross-disciplinary team members; resources adopted organization-wide into the Team Lead Resource Library.

- Designed workflows and content knowledge training for **200+** annotators and team leads, sustaining **90%+** QA performance scores.

Lead Pastor — The Episcopal Church

Bexley, OH · San Francisco, CA · January 2017 – October 2023

- Architected a **custom GPT** for the Episcopal Diocese of Ohio — transforming data across 85 congregations into a planning intelligence tool serving 10,000 members and **\$20M** in annual operating revenue.
- Convened a nine-person cross-functional stakeholder team to co-design organizational vision and mission framework, driving **5% annual growth** in membership and revenue over four years.
- Designed and delivered a full digital learning and worship experience for a 400-member congregation during two years of restricted in-person gathering, earning a **90% approval rating**.

Music Educator and Instructional Designer — North College Hill MS/HS

Cincinnati, OH · June 2010 – January 2014

- Rebuilt a band program from **30 to 75 students** through equity-centered curriculum design, securing instruments for 60% of participants via grants and community partnerships.
- Designed STEAM professional development for 40 faculty and mentored 3 student teachers, modeling equity-centered design, data-informed instruction, and UDL techniques.

PORTFOLIO PROJECTS

Pulmonary Artery Catheterization | Clinical Instructional Design Sample

Canvas-based clinical module with a custom AI tutor and case-based assessments, built with a subject matter expert using Bloom's Taxonomy and backward design in a high-stakes LMS environment.

Intro to Python Programming | Module 1 Instructional Design Sample

Asynchronous Canvas module using backward design, UDL, and DEIJ-informed personas — integrating AI-adaptive LTI assessment and a competency-based capstone aligned to six learning objectives.

Empowering Parents: Using AI to Support Math Learning at Home

Articulate Rise course teaching non-technical parents to use AI tools for Common Core math support — covering prompt engineering, mathematical reasoning strategies, and learner independence.

YMCA Aquatics Continuing Education and Coaching Analytics

Aquatics safety training materials and multimedia content. Data-driven coaching tools including longitudinal performance analytics and individualized progress reports benchmarked against national competency standards.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Purdue University · Certificate in Generative AI Applications · 2025

City College of San Francisco · Certificate in Data Analytics · *In Progress*

Graduate Theological Union · Church Divinity School of the Pacific · Master of Divinity · 2014–2017 · Berkeley, CA

Miami University · Bachelor of Music Education, Minor in Special Education · Oxford, OH